ShopEase Category-Specific Policy Knowledge Base (KB)

Document Owner: Category Management & Customer Experience Team

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Classification: Internal Confidential

1. Electronics & Mobile Devices

1.1 Scope & Return Window

Covers smartphones, laptops, tablets, audio devices, and smart wearables. The standard return/replacement window is **7 days from delivery**.

1.2 Policy Guidelines: Warranty, Repair, and Replacement

- **Dead on Arrival (DOA) / Out of Box Failure:** If a device is defective within the 7-day window, ShopEase provides a direct **Replacement Only** (no refunds unless the item is out of stock).
- **Post 7-Day Defects (Brand Warranty):** Beyond 7 days, ShopEase is no longer liable for replacements. Customers must claim the manufacturer's warranty at an authorized brand service center.
- **Repairs:** ShopEase does not operate in-house repair services for electronics.

1.3 Step-by-Step Resolution (Defect Claim within 7 Days)

1. **Initial Triage:** Ask the customer to perform basic troubleshooting (e.g., hard reset, checking different charging cables).
2. **Brand Certificate Requirement (Mobiles/Laptops):** For high-value electronics, the customer must visit a brand service center and obtain a "DOA Certificate" or "Defect Confirmation Slip" before ShopEase approves the replacement.
3. **Approve Replacement:** Once the certificate is uploaded to the chat/ticket, initiate a reverse pickup.
4. **Dispatch Replacement:** The replacement unit is dispatched only after the defective unit reaches the central hub and passes the IMEI/Serial Number verification check.

2. Large Appliances (TVs, ACs, Refrigerators, Washing Machines)

2.1 Scope & Delivery Operations

Large appliances require specialized handling. Deliveries are typically classified as "Open Box Deliveries" (OBD) to prevent transit damage claims.

2.2 Policy Guidelines

- **Installation & Demo:** Delivery and installation are two separate processes. Installation/Demo is scheduled within **48 business hours** of successful delivery by brand-authorized technicians.
- **Disposal of Old Products (Exchange Program):** If a customer purchased via an "Exchange Offer," the delivery executive will evaluate and pick up the old appliance at the exact time the new appliance is delivered.
- **Open Box Delivery (OBD):** Customers must allow the delivery agent to open the packaging at the doorstep to check for physical damage.

2.3 Step-by-Step Resolution

- **Scenario A: Damage Found During Delivery:** The customer must refuse the delivery. The agent updates the status to "Transit Damage," and an automatic replacement is triggered.
- **Scenario B: Damage Found During Installation:** If the installation technician opens a sealed box and finds internal damage, ask the customer to upload a photo of the technician's report. Initiate an immediate replacement.
- **Scenario C: Delayed Installation:** If 48 hours have passed since delivery, escalate to the Category Logistics > Large Appliances queue to expedite the brand technician. Offer ₹200 ShopEase Wallet credit for the delay.

3. Grocery & FMCG (Fast-Moving Consumer Goods)

3.1 Scope & Nature of Goods

Covers fresh produce, dairy, meat, and packaged food items (FMCG).

3.2 Policy Guidelines

- **Freshness Guarantee:** Perishable goods (fruits, vegetables, dairy, meat) have a **No Return Policy**. If quality is compromised, ShopEase provides a **Direct Refund**.
- **Expiry Complaints:** Packaged goods must have at least 30 days of shelf life remaining at the time of delivery (unless explicitly sold under a "Clearance/Short Expiry" tag).

3.3 Step-by-Step Resolution

1. **Perishable Quality Issue (Reported within 24 hours):**
    - Request a photograph of the spoiled/damaged item.
    - Do not initiate a reverse pickup.
    - Process a partial or full refund directly to the source account based on the quantity damaged.
2. **Expired/Near-Expiry Product Received:**
    - Request a photo clearly showing the manufacturing date (MFG) and expiry date/best before date on the packaging.
    - If the item was expired on delivery or has less than 30 days remaining, process a 100% refund immediately. No return pickup required for food safety reasons.

4. Fashion & Apparel

4.1 Scope & Return Window

Covers clothing, footwear, and accessories. The standard return/exchange window is **14 days from delivery**.

4.2 Policy Guidelines

- **Fit Issues & Size Guides:** ShopEase provides standardized brand size charts, but sizing varies. Fit issues are the #1 reason for returns and are covered under the "No Questions Asked" 14-day policy.
- **Condition of Return:** Items must be unworn, unwashed, and have all original brand tags securely attached.
- **Alterations:** ShopEase **does not** provide custom tailoring or alteration services.
- **Non-Returnable Items:** For hygiene reasons, innerwear, lingerie, swimwear, and socks cannot be returned or exchanged.

4.3 Step-by-Step Resolution (Fit Issue)

1. **Confirm Request:** Check if the item is eligible (not innerwear, within 14 days).
2. **Offer Exchange First:** Ask if the customer prefers a different size. If the desired size is in stock, process a direct Exchange Request.
3. **Refund Alternative:** If out of stock, or if the customer prefers a refund, initiate a Return.
4. **Remind of Tags:** Clearly state to the customer: "Please ensure all original tags are attached, as the pickup agent will check this at your doorstep."

5. Furniture & Home Decor

5.1 Scope & Operations

Covers beds, sofas, wardrobes, and dining tables.

5.2 Policy Guidelines

- **Assembly Services:** ShopEase provides free assembly for products explicitly marked "Assembly Provided." This is done by a specialized carpentry partner within **72 hours** of delivery.
- **Damage on Delivery:** Furniture is highly susceptible to transit damage. Issues must be reported within 3 days.
- **Part Replacement:** To save logistics costs, ShopEase prioritizes shipping missing/damaged components (e.g., a broken table leg, missing screws) rather than replacing the entire bulky unit.

5.3 Step-by-Step Resolution (Damage / Missing Parts)

1. **Identify the Issue:** Ask the customer to use the instruction manual to identify the exact part number/letter that is damaged or missing.
2. **Photo Evidence:** Request photos of the damaged part and the outer packaging.
3. **Resolution Path:**

    - *If a minor part is damaged:* Raise a request with the seller to courier the specific replacement part. Inform the customer of the tracking details.
    - *If the main structural frame is damaged:* Initiate a full reverse pickup and full replacement/refund.

6. Books & Media

6.1 Scope & Common Issues

Covers physical books, academic textbooks, and graphic novels. Common issues include damaged spines, torn pages, or incorrect editions.

6.2 Policy Guidelines

- **Edition Mismatch:** Academic books are highly sensitive to edition changes. If a customer ordered the 10th edition but received the 9th edition, this is classified as an "Item Not As Described" (INAD) defect.
- **Counterfeit Books (Pirated Copies):** ShopEase heavily penalizes sellers shipping photocopied/pirated books disguised as originals.

6.3 Step-by-Step Resolution (Edition Mismatch)

1. **Verify Listing vs. Received Item:** Request a photo of the book cover and the copyright page (showing the edition/year). Compare this to the ShopEase product listing.
2. **Initiate Replacement/Refund:** Create a return request. Offer the customer a refund or a replacement (ensure a different seller fulfills the replacement to avoid a repeat error).
3. **Seller Strike:** Tag the ticket to backend operations to penalize the seller for catalog mismatch.

7. Pharmacy, Health & Wellness

7.1 Scope & Regulatory Compliance

Covers over-the-counter (OTC) medicines, prescription drugs (Rx), supplements, and medical devices. This category has strict legal regulations.

7.2 Policy Guidelines

- **Prescription (Rx) Requirements:** Drugs marked as "Rx Required" cannot be dispatched until a valid prescription from a registered medical practitioner is uploaded by the customer and verified by ShopEase's in-house pharmacists.
- **Cold Chain Products:** Items requiring temperature control (e.g., insulin, certain vaccines) are shipped with ice packs in insulated boxes.
- **Returns Policy: Medicines are strictly non-returnable** once delivered, due to safety and tampering concerns. Refunds are only issued for incorrect/damaged deliveries.
- **Expiry Policy:** Medicines must have a minimum of **6 months** before the expiry date at the time of delivery.

7.3 Step-by-Step Resolution

- **Scenario A: Prescription Rejected:** If the customer asks why their order is stalled, explain that the in-house pharmacist rejected the prescription (e.g., too old, illegible, missing doctor's signature). Ask them to upload a fresh, valid prescription via the App.
- **Scenario B: Expired Medicine Delivered:** Request a photo of the batch number and expiry date. If valid, issue an immediate 100% refund. Direct the customer to safely dispose of the medicine; do not arrange a reverse pickup.
- **Scenario C: Cold Chain Failure:** If the customer reports that an insulin package arrived warm and the ice packs were completely melted, issue an immediate replacement or refund. Raise an SLA breach ticket against the specialized 3PL courier.